



JUDGMENT OFFICER PROFESSION

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Commission and ownership

A consequential Judgment Problem receives a short commission stating the question the officer is charged to understand. It does not imply an answer. Once commissioned, the Judgment Officer owns the problem end to end, preserves context, directs problem-specific collection requirements, and remains personally accountable for the resulting judgment.

Judgment is not “evidence enters a queue and an analyst writes an assessment.” Officers work like case officers, internal investigators, and roving intellectual commissions. They follow the problem across organizational boundaries and remain close enough to evidence and people to notice what a queue would flatten.

Portfolio and curiosity

The working norm is approximately five live problems: four directed from board, Orientation, dissent, JAG, Contact patterns, operating failure, abstention/information deficiency, or other enterprise need; and one self-directed problem. The 20% curiosity outlet is mandatory because ruthless inquiry is part of the profession, but it is bounded: one question, stated importance, and closure or handoff before another opens.

Rights

Within legal/security boundaries an officer may speak directly with people throughout Sable Harbor; attend ordinary operations; visit business lines and sites; sit with collectors; ride with JAG; request records and additional collection through Contact; engage technical and external experts; hold Open Problem Hours; protect sensitive sources appropriately; and ask uncomfortable questions without management gatekeeping.

These rights create access, not command. A JO cannot order a business action merely because the officer holds a judgment. The asymmetric power is the power to compel institutional attention to a question, not operational action.

Problem Book

The Problem Book is a living working record, not a production report. At any time it makes visible: the question; current belief and reasons; evidence and provenance; contrary/missing evidence; assumptions and confidence; what does not make sense; next collection/inquiry; and what would change the officer's mind. “Things that do not make sense” is an affirmative discipline, not an appendix added at publication.

Human access and handoff

Recurring Open Problem Hours let employees walk in, call, share an observation, or challenge reasoning without management filtering. When JAG evidence touches a live problem, the team sits with the officer for conversation and read-back; uploading a report is insufficient.

Problem transfer requires a formal handover, conversation, read-back, current Problem Book, unresolved gaps, sensitive-source handling, and acceptance by the receiving officer. Reassigning a ticket does not transfer understanding.

Judgment Table and dissent

Before issuing a consequential judgment, other Judgment Officers may attack evidence, assumptions, alternative explanations, and confidence. The Table is not a vote or consensus committee. The originating officer remains responsible. Serious dissent travels with the judgment, and multiple interpretations may coexist when reality warrants them.

Closure and self-knowledge

Closure may be resolved, superseded, merged, unresolvable with available evidence, or premise invalid. Labels serve intellectual history rather than throughput management.

Each officer maintains a private longitudinal record of forecasts, confidence, surprise, recurring blind spots, and over/underconfidence. It supports calibration and growth, never a gamified score, ranking, or punishment engine. Report volume, ticket throughput, and document count are poor primary measures. The management question is:

Are you getting closer to the truth?

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